MS2 FINAL

THE LAST BLOOM

VISUALIZING THE SLOW PROCESS OF PSYCHOLOGICAL COLLAPSE

HUANYI LI
LYDIA

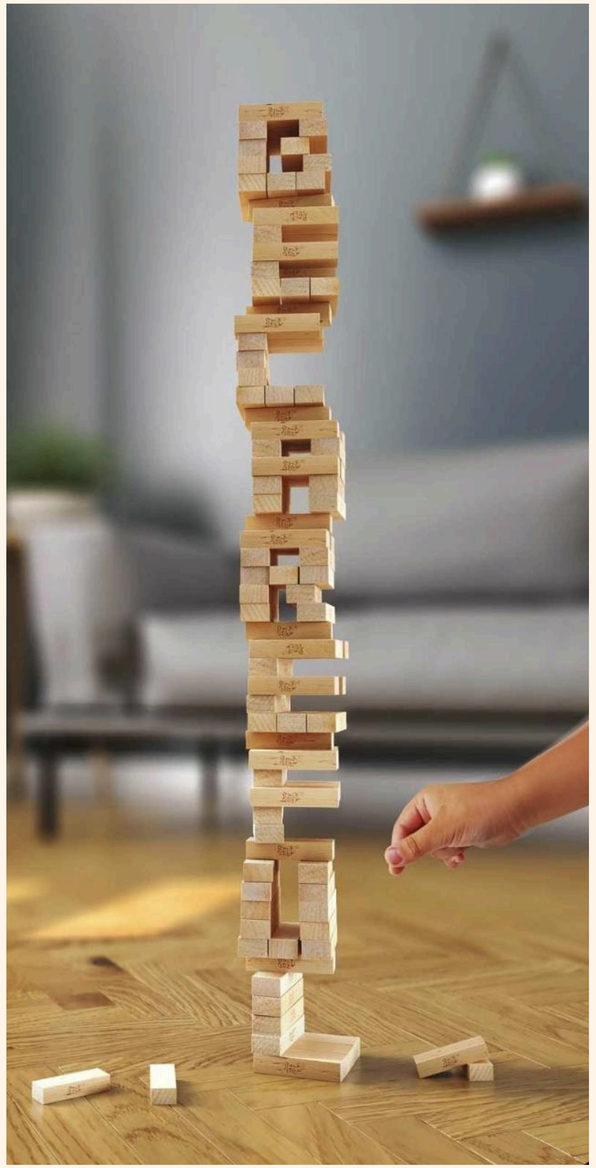


INSPIRATION- “LAST STRAW THAT BROKE CAMEL’S BACK”

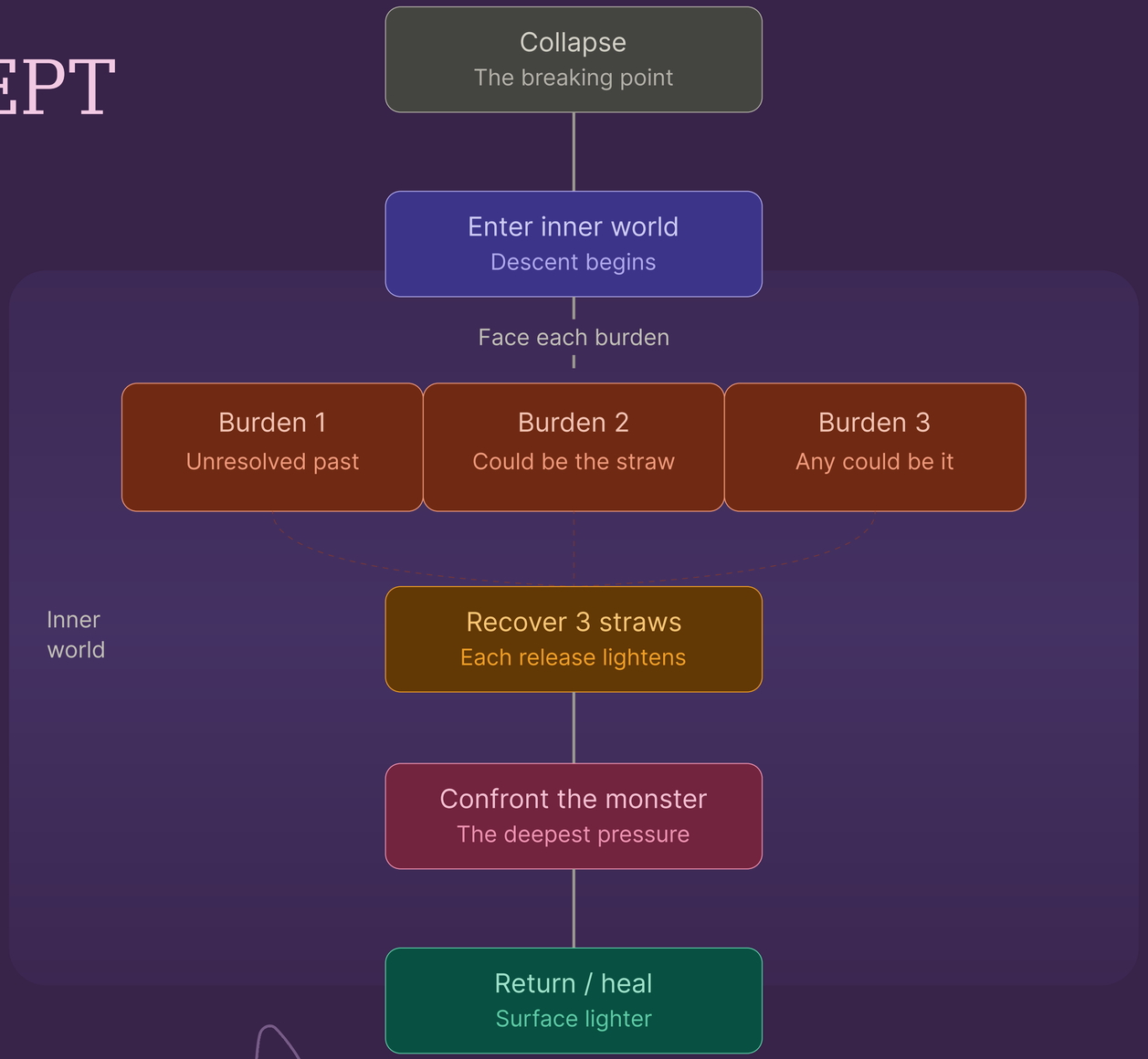
COLLAPSE OFTEN LOOKS SUDDEN BUT ACTUALLY IT BUILDS SLOWLY

Most people think collapse happens in one dramatic moment.
But in reality, it is often the result of many **small pressures accumulating over time.**

The “last straw” is not the whole cause.
It is only the final visible moment, after many unresolved burdens have already been carried.



CORE CONCEPT



The last straw is not one fixed event.
It can be any unresolved burden when the weight is already too much.

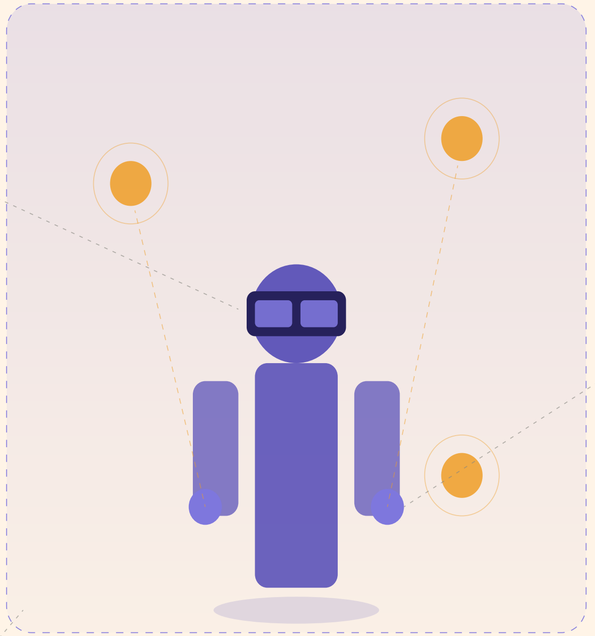
WHY VR AND ESCAPE ROOM?

VR CREATES IMMERSION → MAKES INTERNAL FEELINGS FEEL REAL
ESCAPE ROOM GIVES STRUCTURE → STEP-BY-STEP PROGRESSION



Presence

Inside, not watching



Embodied Interaction

Reach, carry, confront

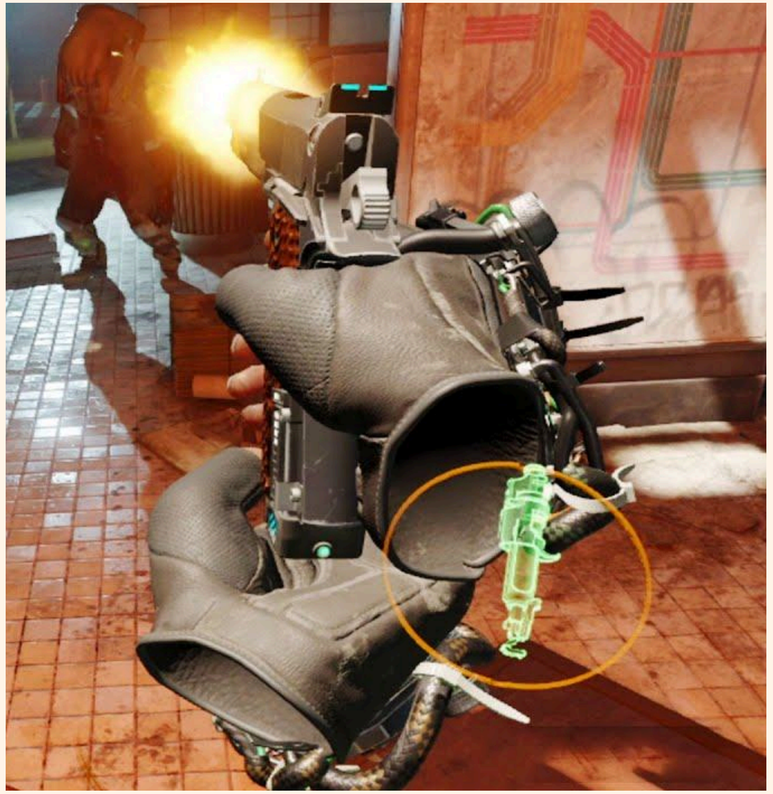
Structure

Each puzzle = one healing step

PRECEDENT



"BRAVEMIND (USC, 2005–PRESENT) — CLINICAL VR PROVES THAT PRESENCE ENABLES PATIENTS TO CONFRONT, NOT AVOID, TRAUMATIC MEMORY."



"HALF-LIFE: ALYX (VALVE, 2020) — ESTABLISHED THE GOLD STANDARD FOR EMBODIED OBJECT INTERACTION IN VR."



"GRIS (NOMADA STUDIO, 2018) — PROVED THAT PUZZLE STRUCTURE CAN EMBODY PSYCHOLOGICAL STAGES OF HEALING."

MAP



Inner distortion
(internal conflict)



Subtle signals (ignored stress)





Final release
(not collapse, but
redemption)



Emotional burden
(personal stress)

ZONE A





Keypad



PASSWORD



Text Clues



Illustration Clues

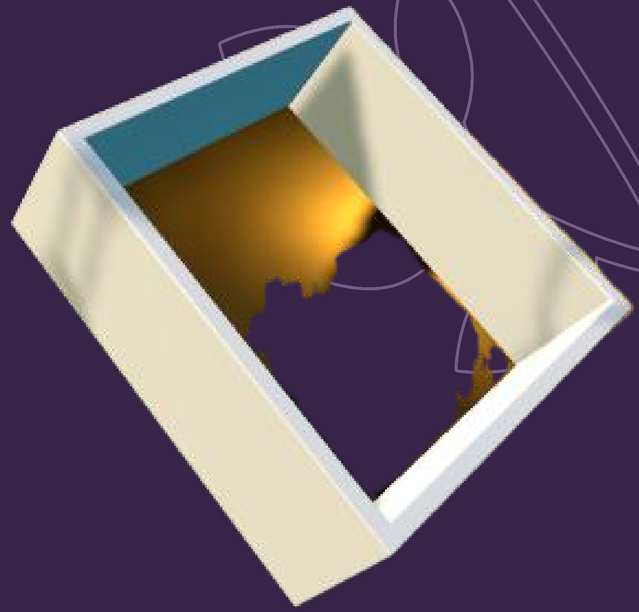
PASSWORD



ZONE B

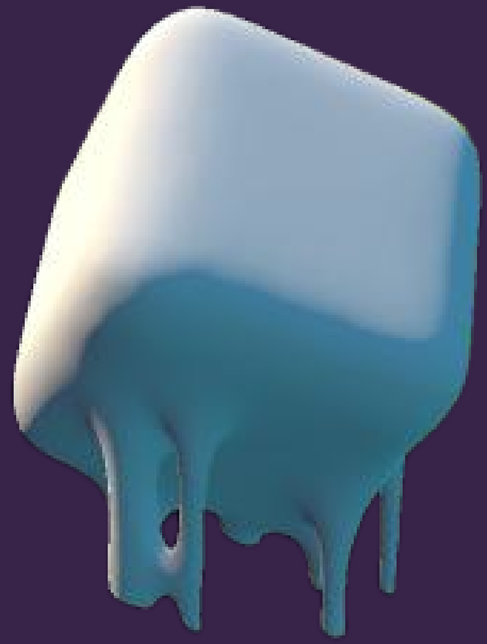






ZONE C





BALANCE SCALE



FINAL STAGE



The final level represents the “last straw.” The pressures that have not been fully resolved come together and take form as a creature. T

COLLAPSE IS NOT THE END.
IT IS WHERE THE GAME
BEGINS.